Dhāraṇī of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Who Completely Clears Away All Lower Realms, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha

Sarvadurgatipariśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 1013 · Derge Kangyur

བཅོམ་ལྡན་འདས་དན་སངོ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཡངོས་སུ་སྤྱེལ་བའི་དེ་བཞིན་གཤེགས་པ་དག་ཏུ་བཅོམ་པ་ཡང་དག་པར་རྫོགས་པའི་སངས་རྒྱས་ཀྱི་གཟུངས

The Dhāraṇī of Purifying All Lower Realms, whose Sanskrit title likely corresponds to Sarvadurgatipariśodhana, is a very brief scripture centered on the Tathāgata whose name in Tibetan, Ngensong Tamché Yongsu Selwa, means "He Who Completely Clears Away All Lower Realms." After paying homage to this buddha, the text gives a short mantra-like incantation, or dhāraṇī, that calls for the purification of all negative deeds and karmic obscurations. It then describes the benefits of memorizing and retaining even a portion of the dhāraṇī: the ability to remember past lives across vast stretches of time, the purification of karmic obscurations, swift attainment of irreversibility on the path, and merit that remains inexhaustible until one reaches awakening. This work is Toh 1013 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the class of short incantation scriptures valued for their protective and purifying power.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Who Completely Clears Away All Lower Realms, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha.

tadyathā oṃ śodhanaṃ viśodhanaṃ viśodhane mama sarva pāpi piśodhane śuddhe viśuddhe sarva karma ābarṇa viṣuddhe svāhā

If any son or daughter of good family thoroughly masters and retains the letters, the words, the names, or the whole of this dhāraṇī, that person will remember their past lives for one million four hundred thousand eons. All their karmic obscurations will be purified, and they will swiftly attain irreversibility. Until they reach the seat of awakening, their merit will never be exhausted.

The dhāraṇī called Purifying All Lower Realms is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Tathāgata's name in the homage, "Who Completely Clears Away All Lower Realms," is translated from the Tibetan. It probably corresponds to the Sanskrit Sarvadurgatipariśodhana, but that form is not certain, so the name is given in English. The title in the colophon, "Purifying All Lower Realms," is also given in English for the same reason.

The phrase "thoroughly masters and retains" renders a Tibetan expression that could also be read as "retains until awakening." The translation follows the sense of the verb byang, "to be well trained in" or "to master."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.